

10 Common Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verb = verb + particle (adverb or preposition)

Learn the meaning, then notice how each one is used in a natural sentence.

1. GET OVER Definition: to recover from something difficult, such as an illness, disappointment, or breakup Example: <i>It took Maria a few months to get over her breakup.</i>	2. FREAK OUT/FLIP OUT Definition: to become very anxious, upset, or frightened; to react strongly Example: <i>I freaked out when I realized I had left my passport at home.</i>
3. COPE WITH Definition: to deal successfully with a difficult situation or emotion Example: <i>She is learning to cope with the stress of her new job.</i>	4. PISS OFF** Definition: to annoy or make someone angry; also, “Piss off!” can mean “Go away!” Example: <i>That constant noise really pisses me off.</i>
5. CHEER UP Definition: to become happier, or to make someone feel happier Example: <i>I called my friend to cheer her up after a difficult day.</i>	6. HAND OUT Definition: to give something to each person in a group Example: <i>The teacher handed out the worksheets before the class started.</i>
7. TUNE IN Definition: to watch or listen to a program, especially at a particular time Example: <i>Tune in at 8 p.m. for the interview.</i>	8. ZONE OUT Definition: to stop paying attention because you are tired, bored, or distracted Example: <i>Sorry—I zoned out for a minute. Could you repeat that?</i>
9. CARRY ON Definition: to continue doing something Example: <i>Even though it was raining, they carried on with the game.</i>	10. MOVE ON Definition: to continue with your life after a difficult experience; to stop focusing on the past Example: <i>After the argument, we apologized and decided to move on.</i>

⚠️ ****Note:** “Piss off” is vulgar and informal. It is common in casual speech but is not appropriate in formal or professional situations.

PHRASAL VERB PRACTICE

1. Quick Match

Match each phrasal verb (1–10) with the correct meaning (A–J).

1. get over	2. freak out
3. cope with	4. piss off
5. cheer up	6. hand out
7. tune in	8. zone out
9. carry on	10. move on

- A. continue doing something
B. become very anxious, upset, or frightened
C. give something to each person in a group
D. recover from a difficult experience
E. make someone happier
F. stop paying attention because you are distracted or tired
G. deal successfully with a difficult situation
H. annoy or make someone angry
I. watch or listen to a program
J. continue with your life after a difficult experience

2. Complete the Sentences

Use the correct phrasal verb from the box. Change the form if necessary.

get over • freak out • cope with • piss off • cheer up • hand out • tune in • zone out • carry on • move on

1. I was so tired during the meeting that I completely _____ for a few minutes.
2. The teacher will _____ the exam papers at the beginning of the class.
3. Don't _____! Everything is going to be OK.
4. It took him a long time to _____ his divorce.
5. How do you _____ stress at work?
6. That rude comment really _____ me _____.
7. _____ at 9 p.m. tonight for the live concert.
8. She bought her friend some flowers to _____ her _____.
9. The weather was terrible, but they decided to _____ with the hike.
10. The relationship ended, and now she's ready to _____.

3. Choose the Best Answer

1. After losing his job, Daniel needed some time to _____. A) move on B) hand out C) tune in
2. My sister always _____ when she has to speak in public. A) cheers up B) freaks out C) hands out
3. Please _____ with your work while I answer the phone. A) carry on B) get over C) zone out
4. This documentary is interesting. _____ at 7:30 tonight. A) Piss off B) Tune in C) Cheer up
5. I can't concentrate today. I keep _____ during meetings. A) zoning out B) moving on C) handing out
6. He finally _____ the flu and went back to work. A) got over B) pissed off C) tuned in

4. Rewrite the Sentence

Rewrite each sentence using the phrasal verb in brackets. Keep the meaning the same.

1. She recovered from the disappointment after a few weeks. (get over)

2. The manager gave every employee a copy of the new policy. (hand out)

3. He became extremely anxious when he couldn't find his phone. (freak out)

4. We need to continue working until the project is finished. (carry on)

5. It's time to stop thinking about the past and continue with your life. (move on)

5. Make It Personal

Answer the questions using complete sentences. Try to use the phrasal verbs naturally.

1. What is something you found difficult to get over?

2. What situations make you freak out?

3. How do you cope with stress?

4. What is something that really pisses you off?

5. What usually cheers you up when you're having a bad day?

6. When do you zone out?



ANSWER KEY

1. Quick Match

1-D 2-B 3-G 4-H 5-E 6-C 7-I 8-F 9-A 10-J

2. Complete the Sentences

1. zoned out
2. hand out
3. freak out
4. get over
5. cope with
6. pissed / off
7. Tune in
8. cheer / up
9. carry on
10. move on

3. Choose the Best Answer

1. A — move on
2. B — freaks out
3. A — carry on
4. B — Tune in
5. A — zoning out
6. A — got over

4. Rewrite It — Sample Answers

1. She got over the disappointment after a few weeks.
2. The manager handed out a copy of the new policy to every employee.
3. He freaked out when he couldn't find his phone.
4. We need to carry on working until the project is finished.
5. It's time to move on.

